Dua Sha'baniyya

DUA SHA'BANIYYA
(THE WHISPERED PRAYER OF SHA'BAN)

The dua or munajat has been taught by Imam Ali (pbuh).
It contains sublime themes teaching us how to beseech Allah, how to tell Him the secrets of the heart, how to offer apologies and how to remain hopeful. Also in this dua, the meanings of the interpretation of God's countenance (Laqa), God's witnessing (Shahood)and God's nearness (Qurb) have been described

بِسْمِ اللّٰهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ

In the name of Allah, the Beneficient, the Merciful

اَللّٰهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلٰى مُحَمَّدٍ وَّاٰلِ مُحَمَّدٍ

O Allah! Send blessing on Muhammad and his Ahlulbayt

وَاسْمَعْ دُعَآئِى اِذَا دَعَوْتُكَ وَاسْمَعْ نِدَآئِى اِذَا نَادَيْتُكَ وَاَقْبِلْ عَلَيَّ اِذَا نَاجَيْتُكَ

Respond to my prayer when I pray to You; listen to my call when I call You; and turn to me when I make my submission to You in confidence.

فَقَدْ هَرَبْتُ اِلَيْكَ وَوَقَفْتُ بَيْنَ يَدَيْكَ مُسْتَكِيْنًا لَّكَ مُتَضَرِّعًا اِلَيْكَ رَاجِيًا لِّمَا لَدَيْكَ ثَوَابِيْ

I have come running to You and am standing before You imploring You in humility and hoping to get the reward You have for me.

وَتَعْلَمُ مَا فِيْ نَفْسِيْ وَتَخْبُرُ حَاجَتِيْ

You know what is in my heart, and You are aware of what I need.

وَتَعْرِفُ ضَمِيرِي وَلَا يَخْفَى عَلَيْكَ
أَمْرُ مُنْقَلَبِي وَمَثْوَايَ

You know my mind and are not unaware of my future and of my present,

وَمَا أُرِيدُ أَنْ أُبْدِئَ بِهِ مِنْ مَنْطِقِي
وَأَتَفَوَّهُ بِهِ مِنْ طَلِبَتِي وَأَرْجُوهُ
لِعَاقِبَتِي وَقَدْ جَرَتْ مَقَادِيرُكَ عَلَيَّ

of what I want to begin my speech with; of the request I would utter, and of the hopes I have in regard to my ultimate lot.

يَا سَيِّدِي فِيمَا يَكُونُ مِنِّي إِلَى آخِرِ
عُمْرِي مِنْ سَرِيرَتِي وَعَلَانِيَتِي
وَبِيَدِكَ لَا بِيَدِ غَيْرِكَ زِيَادَتِي
وَنَقْصِي وَنَفْعِي وَضَرِّي

My Rabb, whatever You have destined for me up to the end of my life, whether concerning the open aspect of my life or the hidden aspect
of it, is bound to come. What is to my advantage and what is to my disadvantage - all my losses and gains are in Your hand, not in the hand of anybody else.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ حَرَمْتَنِي فَمَنْ ذَا الَّذِي
يَرْزُقُنِي وَاِنْ خَذَلْتَنِي فَمَنْ ذَا الَّذِي
يَنْصُرُنِي

My Rabb, if You deprive me, who else will provide me; and if You let me down, who else will help me?

اِلٰهِي اَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ غَضَبِكَ وَحُلُولِ
سَخَطِكَ

My Rabb, I seek Your protection from Your anger and from earning Your displeasure.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ كُنْتُ غَيْرَ مُسْتَاْهِلٍ
لِرَحْمَتِكَ فَاَنْتَ اَهْلٌ اَنْ تَجُودَ عَلَيَّ
بِفَضْلِ سَعَتِكَ

If I am not fit for gaining Your Mercy, You are certainly fit to be generous to me by virtue of Your Magnanimity.

اِلٰهِي كَاَنِّي بِنَفْسِي وَاقِفَةٌ بَيْنَ يَدَيْكَ
وَقَدْ اَظَلَّهَا حُسْنُ تَوَكُّلِي عَلَيْكَ
فَقُلْتَ مَا اَنْتَ اَهْلُهُ وَتَغَمَّدْتَنِي
بِعَفْوِكَ

My Rabb, I see as if I am standing before You protected by my trust in You. You said what befitted You and covered me with Your forgiveness.

اِلٰهِيْ اِنْ عَفَوْتَ فَمَنْ اَوْلٰى مِنْكَ بِذٰلِكَ

My Rabb, if You forgive me, then who is more suited than You to do that?

وَاِنْ كَانَ قَدْ دَنَا اَجَلِيْ وَلَمْ يُدْنِنِيْ مِنْكَ عَمَلِيْ فَقَدْ جَعَلْتُ الْاِقْرَارِ بِالذَّنْبِ اِلَيْكَ وَسِيْلَتِيْ

If the time of my death has come near and my deeds have not still brought me close to You, I make this confession of my sins a means of approaching You.

اِلٰهِيْ قَدْ جُرْتُ عَلٰى نَفْسِيْ فِي النَّظَرِ لَهَا فَلَهَا الْوَيْلُ اِنْ لَّمْ تَغْفِرْ لَهَا

I have been unjust to my soul for I have not looked after it. It will certainly be doomed if You do not forgive it.

اِلٰهِيْ لَمْ يَزَلْ بِرُّكَ عَلَيَّ اَيَّامَ حَيٰوتِيْ فَلَا تَقْطَعْ بِرَّكَ عَنِّيْ فِيْ مَمَاتِيْ

My Rabb, You have always been kind to me during my life time. Therefore do not cut off Your favour from me at the time of my death.

اِلٰهِيْ كَيْفَ اٰيَسُ مِنْ حُسْنِ نَظَرِكَ لِيْ بَعْدَ مَمَاتِيْ وَاَنْتَ لَمْ تُوَلِّنِيْ اِلَّا الْجَمِيْلَ فِيْ حَيٰوتِيْ

My Rabb, how can I lose the hope, of Your looking kindly, in me after my death, when you have always been good to me during my life.

اِلٰهِيْ تَوَلَّ مِنْ اَمْرِيْ مَآ اَنْتَ اَهْلُهُ وَعُدْ عَلَيَّ بِفَضْلِكَ عَلٰى مُذْنِبٍ قَدْ غَمَرَهُ جَهْلُهُ

My Rabb, in my case do what befits You and bestow Your favour on me, a sinner enwrapped in his ignorance.

اِلٰهِيْ قَدْ سَتَرْتَ عَلَيَّ ذُنُوْبًا فِي الدُّنْيَا

My Rabb, You have concealed many of my sins in this world.

وَاَنَا اَحْوَجُ اِلٰى سَتْرِهَا عَلَيَّ مِنْكَ فِي الْاُخْرٰى

I am in a greater need of their being conceded in the next.

اِلٰهِيْ قَدْ اَحْسَنْتَ اِلَيَّ اِذْ لَمْ تُظْهِرْهَا لِاَحَدٍ مِّنْ عِبَادِكَ الصَّالِحِيْنَ

As You have not revealed my sins even to any of Your pious abd,

فَلَا تَفْضَحْنِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ عَلَىٰ رُؤُسِ الْأَشْهَادِ

do not expose me on the Day of Resurrection before everybody.

إِلٰهِي جُودُكَ بَسَطَ أَمَلِي وَعَفْوُكَ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ عَمَلِي

My Rabb, Your generosity has expanded my aspiration, and Your forgiveness is superior to my deeds.

إِلٰهِي فَسُرَّنِي بِلِقَائِكَ يَوْمَ تَقْضِي فِيهِ بَيْنَ عِبَادِكَ

Therefore gladden my heart by allowing me to meet You on the day You administer justice to Your abd.

إِلٰهِي اِعْتِذَارِي إِلَيْكَ اعْتِذَارُ مَنْ لَمْ يَسْتَغْنِ عَنْ قَبُولِ عُذْرِهِ

My Rabb, my apology to You is the apology of him who cannot afford his apology being not accepted.

فَاقْبَلْ عُذْرِي يَا أَكْرَمَ مَنِ اعْتَذَرَ إِلَيْهِ الْمُسِيئُونَ

Therefore accept my apology, You the Most Magnanimous of those to whom the evil-doers tender their apology.

اِلٰهِي لَا تَرُدَّ حَاجَتِي وَلَا تُخَيِّبْ طَمَعِي
وَلَا تَقْطَعْ مِنْكَ رَجَآئِي وَاَمَلِي

My Rabb, do not turn down my request; do not foil my desire; and do not cut off my hope and expectation of You.

اِلٰهِي لَوْ اَرَدْتَّ هَوَانِي لَمْ تَهْدِنِي وَلَوْ
اَرَدْتَّ فَضِيحَتِي لَمْ تُعَافِنِي

My Rabb, if You had wanted to disgrace me, You would not have guided me; and if You had wanted to expose my faults and vices, You would not have kept me safe and sound.

اِلٰهِي مَآ اَظُنُّكَ تَرُدُّنِي فِي حَاجَةٍ قَدْ
اَفْنَيْتُ عُمْرِي فِي طَلَبِهَا مِنْكَ

My Rabb, I do not think that You will turn down my request for that in asking You for which I have spent my whole life.

اِلٰهِي فَلَكَ الْحَمْدُ اَبَدًا دَآئِمًا
سَرْمَدًا يَزِيدُ وَلَا يَبِيدُ كَمَا تُحِبُّ وَ
تَرْضٰى

My Rabb, all praise is due to You, always and for ever, growing not diminishing, as You like and please.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ اَخَذْتَنِي بِجُرْمِي اَخَذْتُكَ بِعَفْوِكَ

My Rabb, if You condemn me for my crimes,

وَاِنْ اَخَذْتَنِي بِذُنُوبِي اَخَذْتُكَ بِمَغْفِرَتِكَ

I will cling to Your forgiveness, and if You hold me for my sins,

وَاِنْ اَدْخَلْتَنِي النَّارَ اَعْلَمْتُ اَهْلَهَا اَنِّي اُحِبُّكَ

I will cling to Your granting pardon. If You haul me into the hell, I will tell its inmates that I love You.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ كَانَ صَغُرَ فِي جَنْبِ طَاعَتِكَ عَمَلِي

My Rabb, if my deeds are too small in relation to how I should obey You,

فَقَدْ كَبُرَ فِي جَنْبِ رَجَآئِكَ اَمَلِي

my aspirations are high enough as compared to what I should expect of You.

اِلٰهِي كَيْفَ اَنْقَلِبُ مِنْ عِنْدِكَ
بِالْخَيْبَةِ مَحْرُوماً وَقَدْ كَانَ حُسْنُ ظَنِّي
بِجُودِكَ اَنْ تَقْلِبَنِي بِالنَّجَاةِ مَرْحُوماً

My Rabb, how can I go away from You unsuccessful and disappointed, when I had a high hope that You will be kind enough to send me away enjoying safety and deliverance.

اِلٰهِي وَقَدْ اَفْنَيْتُ عُمُرِي فِي شِرَّةِ
السَّهْوِ عَنْكَ وَاَبْلَيْتُ شَبَابِي فِي
سَكْرَةِ التَّبَاعُدِ مِنْكَ

My Rabb, I have wasted my life committing the crime of forgetting You and played havoc with my youth, intoxicated with keeping myself away from You.

اِلٰهِي فَلَمْ اَسْتَيْقِظْ اَيَّامَ اغْتِرَارِي
بِكَ وَرُكُونِي اِلٰى سَبِيلِ سَخَطِكَ

My Rabb, I did not wake up when I was under a delusion about You and was inclined to earn Your displeasure.

اِلٰهِي وَاَنَا عَبْدُكَ وَابْنُ عَبْدِكَ قَآئِمٌ
بَيْنَ يَدَيْكَ مُتَوَسِّلٌ بِكَرَمِكَ اِلَيْكَ

My Rabb, I am Your abd, son of Your abd. I am standing before You, trying to use Your own magnanimity as a means of approaching You.

اِلٰهِي اَنَا عَبْدٌ اَتَنَصَّلُ اِلَيْكَ مِمَّا كُنْتُ
اُوَاجِهُكَ بِهِ مِنْ قِلَّةِ اسْتِحْيَآئِي مِنْ
نَّظَرِكَ

My Rabb, I am an abd of Yours, I want to rid myself of the sins I used to commit in Your presence because I lacked the sense of feeling ashamed that You were looking at me.

وَاَطْلُبُ الْعَفْوَ مِنْكَ اِذِ الْعَفْوُ نَعْتٌ
لِكَرَمِكَ

I request You to forgive me, because forgiveness is a characteristic of Your Kindness.

اِلٰهِي لَمْ يَكُنْ لِي حَوْلٌ فَانْتَقِلَ بِهِ
عَنْ مَعْصِيَتِكَ اِلَّا فِي وَقْتٍ اَيْقَظْتَنِي
لِمَحَبَّتِكَ

My Rabb, I was not strong enough to move away from Your disobedience, except when You awakened me to Your love.

وَكَمَا اَرَدْتَّ اَنْ اَكُونَ كُنْتُ
فَشَكَرْتُكَ بِاِدْخَالِي فِي كَرَمِكَ

I was exactly as You wanted me to be. I am thankful to You for introducing me to Your Kindness and purging my heart of the impurities of being inattentive to You.

وَلِتَطْهِيرِ قَلْبِي مِنْ أَوْسَاخِ الْغَفْلَةِ عَنْكَ

اِلٰهِي اُنْظُرْ اِلَيَّ نَظَرَ مَنْ نَادَيْتَهُ فَأَجَابَكَ وَاسْتَعْمَلْتَهُ بِمَعُونَتِكَ فَأَطَاعَكَ

My Rabb, look upon me as the person whom You called and he responded to You, whom You helped by using his services, and he obeyed You.

يَا قَرِيبًا لَا يَبْعُدُ عَنِ الْمُغْتَرِّ بِهِ وَيَا جَوَادًا لَا يَبْخَلُ عَمَّنْ رَجَا ثَوَابَهُ

The Near One, Who is not far from one who is away from You. The Munificent, Who does not withhold His reward from one who hopes for it.

اِلٰهِي هَبْ لِي قَلْبًا يُدْنِيهِ مِنْكَ شَوْقُهُ

My Rabb, provide me with a heart, the passion of which may bring it near You,

وَلِسَانًا يُرْفَعُ اِلَيْكَ صِدْقُهُ

with a tongue the truth of which may be submitted to You,

وَنَظَرًا يُّقَرِّبُهُ مِنْكَ حَقُّهُ

and with a vision the nature of which may bring it close to You.

اِلٰهِيْ اِنَّ مَنْ تَعَرَّفَ بِكَ غَيْرُ مَجْهُوْلٍ

My Rabb, whoever gets acquainted with You, is not unknown;

وَّمَنْ لَاذَ بِكَ غَيْرُ مَخْذُوْلٍ وَمَنْ

اَقْبَلْتَ عَلَيْهِ غَيْرُ مَمْلُوْكٍ

whoever takes shelter under You, is not disappointed; and one to whom You turn, is not a slave.

اِلٰهِيْ اِنَّ مَنِ انْتَهَجَ بِكَ لَمُسْتَنِيْرٌ وَّاِنَّ

مَنِ اعْتَصَمَ بِكَ لَمُسْتَجِيْرٌ وَقَدْ

لُذْتُ بِكَ

One who follows Your path is enlightened; and one who takes refuge in You, is saved.

يَا اِلٰهِيْ فَلَا تُخَيِّبْ ظَنِّيْ مِنْ رَّحْمَتِكَ

وَلَا تَحْجُبْنِيْ عَنْ رَّاْفَتِكَ

My Rabb, I have taken refuge in You. Therefore do not disappoint me of Your Mercy and do not keep me secluded from Your Kindness.

اِلٰهِيْ اَقِمْنِيْ فِيْ اَهْلِ وِلَايَتِكَ مُقَامَ مَنْ رَجَآءَ الزِّيَادَةِ مِنْ مَحَبَّتِكَ

My Rabb, place me among your friends in the position of one who hopes for an increase in Your love.

اِلٰهِيْ وَالْهِمْنِيْ وَلَهًا بِذِكْرِكَ اِلٰى ذِكْرِكَ

My Rabb, inspire me with a passionate love of remembering You so that I may keep on remembering You,

وَهِمَّتِيْ فِيْ رَوْحِ نَجَاحِ اَسْمَآئِكَ وَمَحَلِّ قُدْسِكَ

and by Your Holy Name and Pure Position cherish my cheerful determination into a success.

اِلٰهِيْ بِكَ عَلَيْكَ اِلَّا اَلْحَقْتَنِيْ بِمَحَلِّ اَهْلِ طَاعَتِكَ وَالْمَثْوٰى الصَّالِحِ مِنْ مَرْضَاتِكَ

My Rabb, I invoke You to admit me to the place reserved for those who obey You, and to attach me to the nice abode of those who enjoy Your good pleasure ...

فَإِنِّي لَا أَقْدِرُ لِنَفْسِي دَفْعًا وَلَا أَمْلِكُ لَهَا نَفْعًا

I can neither defend myself nor do I control what is advantageous for me.

إِلٰهِي أَنَا عَبْدُكَ الضَّعِيفُ الْمُذْنِبُ وَمَمْلُوكُكَ الْمُنِيبُ

My Rabb, I am Your powerless sinning slave and Your repentant abd.

فَلَا تَجْعَلْنِي مِمَّنْ صَرَفْتَ عَنْهُ وَجْهَكَ وَحَجَبَهُ سَهْوُهُ عَنْ عَفْوِكَ

So do not make me one of those from whom You turn away Your face, and whom his negligence has secluded from Your forgiveness.

إِلٰهِي هَبْ لِي كَمَالَ الْإِنْقِطَاعِ إِلَيْكَ وَأَنِرْ أَبْصَارَ قُلُوبِنَا بِضِيَآءِ نَظَرِهَا إِلَيْكَ

My Rabb, grant me complete severance of my relations with everything else and total submission to You.

حَتّٰى تَخْرِقَ أَبْصَارُ الْقُلُوبِ حُجُبَ النُّورِ فَتَصِلَ إِلٰى مَعْدِنِ الْعَظَمَةِ

Enlighten the eyes of our hearts with the light of their looking at You to the extent that they penetrate the veils of light and reach the Source of Grandeur,

وَتَصِيرَ أَرْوَاحُنَا مُعَلَّقَةً بِعِزِّ قُدْسِكَ

and let our souls get suspended by the glory of Your sanctity.

إِلٰهِي وَاجْعَلْنِي مِمَّنْ نَادَيْتَهُ فَأَجَابَكَ

My Rabb make me one of those whom You call, and they respond;

وَلَاحَظْتَهُ فَصَعِقَ لِجَلَالِكَ

when You look at and they are thunderstruck by Your majesty.

فَنَاجَيْتَهُ سِرًّا وَعَمِلَ لَكَ جَهْرًا

You whisper to them secretly and they work for You openly.

إِلٰهِي لَمْ أُسَلِّطْ عَلَى حُسْنِ ظَنِّي قُنُوطَ الْأَيَاسِ

My Rabb, I have not allowed my pessimistic despair to overcome my good opinion about You,

وَلَا انْقَطَعَ رَجَائِي مِنْ جَمِيلِ كَرَمِكَ

nor did I ever lose my hope of Your benevolence.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ كَانَتِ الْخَطَايَا قَدْ اَسْقَطَتْنِي لَدَيْكَ فَاصْفَحْ عَنِّي بِحُسْنِ تَوَكُّلِي عَلَيْكَ

My Rabb, if my errors have degraded me with You, You may forgive me in view of my unqualified reliance on You.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ حَطَّتْنِي الذُّنُوبُ مِنْ مَكَارِمِ لُطْفِكَ فَقَدْ نَبَّهَنِي الْيَقِينُ اِلٰى كَرَمِ عَطْفِكَ

My Rabb, if my sins have made me unfit to receive Your tender affection, my firm belief has reminded me of Your Compassion.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ اَنَامَتْنِي الْغَفْلَةُ عَنِ الْاِسْتِعْدَادِ لِلِقَآئِكَ فَقَدْ نَبَّهَتْنِي الْمَعْرِفَةُ بِكَرَمِ الَآئِكَ

My Rabb, if my disregard for preparations to meet You has put me to sleep, my knowledge of Your kind bounties has awakened me.

اِلٰهِي اِنْ دَعَانِي اِلَى النَّارِ عَظِيمُ عِقَابِكَ فَقَدْ دَعَانِي اِلَى الْجَنَّةِ جَزِيلُ ثَوَابِكَ

My Rabb, if Your severe punishment calls me to Hell, the abundance of Your reward invites me to Paradise.

My Rabb, I ask You and pray to You earnestly,

اِلٰهِي فَلَكَ اَسْئَلُ وَاِلَيْكَ اَبْتَهِلُ

I desire and request You to show Your favour to Muhammad and his descendants,

وَاَرْغَبُ وَاَسْئَلُكَ اَنْ تُصَلِّيَ عَلٰى مُحَمَّدٍ وَّاٰلِ مُحَمَّدٍ

make me one of those who always remember You and never violate the pledge they make to You,

وَاَنْ تَجْعَلَنِي مِمَّنْ يُدِيمُ ذِكْرَكَ وَلَا يَنْقُضُ عَهْدَكَ

who do not fail, to show You their gratitude and do not take Your orders lightly.

وَلَا يَغْفُلُ عَنْ شُكْرِكَ وَلَا يَسْتَخِفُّ بِاَمْرِكَ

My Rabb let me be attached to the Light of Your Majestic Glory, so that I may know You alone, be away from others,

اِلٰهِي وَاَلْحِقْنِي بِنُورِ عِزِّكَ الْاَبْهَجِ فَاَكُونَ لَكَ عَارِفًا وَعَنْ سِوَاكَ مُنْحَرِفًا

وَمِنْكَ خَآئِفًا مُرَاقِبًا يَا

ذَا الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

وَصَلَّى اللهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَّآلِهِ

الطَّاهِرِيْنَ وَسَلَّمَ تَسْلِيْمًا

كَثِيْرًا

and have a heart fearful of You and an eye watchful of You.

May Allah's blessing and peace be on Muhammad and those of his descendants who are pure.

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